The Deed, the Statements, the Beneficiary Forms

Mom's ownership papers in one place: where each one is, who holds it, and which ones you haven't found yet.

The deed is in a file cabinet at the house, the statements go to three different addresses, and the beneficiary forms were filled out so long ago that no one remembers what they say.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it. It asks where each paper is, how recent it is, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
The list of what Mom and Dad own, if one has been made			
The deed to the house			
A recent statement for each bank and savings account			
A recent statement for each retirement account			
Beneficiary forms for the retirement accounts and the insurance policies			
Trust papers, if there is a trust			
Insurance policies			
Papers for anything owned jointly with someone else			
Letters or notices you've received about the house or the accounts, including any that mention a lien or estate recovery			
Paperwork from any legal or financial planning already done, and who prepared it			
Your notes of what you've been told so far, and by whom			

What's missing, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE No beneficiary form for Mom's retirement account. Karen will call the plan and ask for a copy of what's on file.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here. Just say where it is.
- Leave the originals where they are kept, and note where that is.
- Bring this page, with copies of the papers, to the conversation with your Medicaid planner.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any deed, statement, form or notice means, for Medicaid or for anything else. If you read something you don't understand, write it down as a question for your Medicaid planner or for an elder law attorney. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each paper is, who has it and what hasn't turned up yet. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report. With this page beside you, more of your answers can come from the papers and fewer from memory.

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